

INTRODUCTION TO ETHICS

Ethics

- Came from:
 - the Greek word Ethos – characteristic way of acting
 - The Latin word Mores – customary, traditions
- Science of human actions / morals
- Science of the morality of human actions
 - Morality – quality of human actions
- An art – ethics brings out the best in us

Ethos can be indicated by:

- Distinguishing right from wrong
- Avoiding evil / bad things
- Accepting reward / punishment

Categories of Morality

- Good morality (virtues)
- Bad morality (vices)
- Indifference
 - Moral
 - Immoral
 - Ammoral

Human Characteristics

- Morals
- Intellect
- Ability to make decisions (will)
- Rationalize ideas
- Appreciate beauty
- To love
- Poetic and abstract knowledge
- Ability to communicate (language)

Human Beings as Ethical Person

- With sense and abstract knowledge
- With moral and religious capacity
- Language and arts

Language and Arts

1. Verbal (Words)

2. Non-verbal

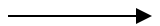
- Elements: Chemical, Mathematical (numbers, letters), Graphical (images, pictures, tables, figures)

3. Paralanguage / Extra Verbal

- Gestures, Movements, Dress Code, Space, Color

Human Nature

- Dualism / Human Nature
 - Body and Soul/Spirit
 - The soul is the dwelling place of God
 - The soul dominates the time and death (immortality)
- MAN has body and soul.



Human Nature

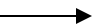
- The soul has:
 - Vegetative powers (plants and animals)
 - Nutrition, growth, reproduction
 - Sensitive powers (animals)
 - Memorization, sense appetites- like sex, food, etc.
 - Rational (intellect / free will) powers (man)
 - Recognition, recall, analysing, judgment

Human Means and Ends

● Means Actions - Education / schooling - Good life	Ends Outcome/Result - Degree / job - death/union with the Almighty
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Human Means and Ends

- Good life → Actions → Virtues (2 kinds)
 - Moral - right way of doing things
 - Prudence
 - Justice
 - Fortitude
 - Temperance
 - Intellectual – knowing how to do things
 - Speculative
 - Practical

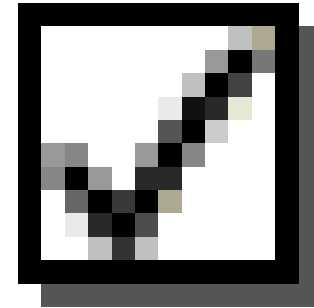


Human Means and Ends

- Speculative → Understanding, Science, Wisdom
- Practical → Art, Prudence
 - Art
 - Liberal
 - Composition – by the mind, in the mind, for the mind
 - Fine
 - Painting – by the mind, not in the mind, for the mind
 - Useful
 - Chair-making – by the mind, not in the mind, not for the mind

Ethics Check

- Is it legal?
 - Civil law
 - Company policy
 - School policy
- Is it balanced?
 - Fair
 - Win-win
- How will it make me feel about myself?
 - Proud
 - Feel good



Activity 1.2 *(1 page per Question) – 10 points*

1. Define ethics as a science and an art. Give its importance to every person and organization. *(10 points)*
2. Discuss the nature of man in terms of the dual theory. Include the unique characteristics of humans in line with their rational powers. *(10 points)*

End of Week 1

Week 2

5 P's of Ethical Power

- Purpose
 - See self as ethically sound person
 - Conscience as guide
 - No matter what happens – can able to face the mirror, look the self straight in the eye
- Pride
 - Feel good about the self
 - Don't need the acceptance of other people to feel important
 - A balanced self-esteem keeps the ego and desire to be accepted from influencing decisions

5 P's of Ethical Power

- Patience
 - Believing that things will eventually work out well
 - At peace with what comes the way
- Persistence
 - Sticking to purpose, especially when it seems inconvenient to do so
 - Behaviour is consistent with intentions
 - Never, never, never, never give up! [*Churchill*]

5 P's of Ethical Power

- Perspective
 - Taking time to enter each day quietly in a mood of reflection
 - Getting one's self focused
 - Allowing to listen to the inner self
 - Seeing things more clearly

Ethics is related with:

- Values Education
- Religion
- Psychology
- Art

Ancient Greek Ethics (Classical Period)

- Socrates
 - Has good thoughts but he left no writings of his ideas.
 - “Knowledge is virtue.” → knowledge-wise | virtue-good
 - Extension of knowledge is ACTION → well—disciplined, cultured
→ just, courageous, even-tempered, wise, provident
 - He believes that man is generally good and is not evil.
 - Man is evil because of ignorance.
 - Happiness is doing what is good, right, and proper; and the ultimate goal of man.
 - Only man can be happy because only man is rational and only man is rational.
 - “Know thyself.”
 - “The unexplained life is not worth living.”

Ancient Greek Ethics (Classical Period)

- Plato

- Has lots of writings about Socrates
- Favorite student of Socrates
- Known by his idealism

idea / spirit / soul / mind

- IDEAlism =

body / matter / physique

- Idea / spirit / soul / mind → eternal, everlasting, infinite, absolute, permanent
- Body / matter / physique → temporary; transitory; fleeting
- “Marriage of true minds lasts.”

Ancient Greek Ethics (Classical Period)

- Aristotle

- Biologist

- Started the concept of realism

matter

- Realism =

mind

- The Doctrine of the Golden Mean.

MEAN

(Moderation)

(Temperance)

- Excessiveness ---

--- Deficiency

- Tall tree/high person – average – short tree/low person

- Flattery/insincere/praise – friendliness – quarrelsomeness

- Pleasure – moderation – pain

- Empty/vanity – pride – undue/humility

Ancient Roman

- Marcus Fabius Quintilianus: Quintilian
 - “An orator is a good man speaking well.”
 - A good man has ethical qualities: fairness/justice, courage, sincerity, tact.

Middle Ages (Medieval Period) 14th-15th Century

- Jesus Christ
 - Ethics: Humanitarianism
 - Faith (Divine Providence)
 - Reconciliation and forgiveness
 - Love
 - Unselfishness – showing preferences for the oppressed, poor, unprivileged
 - Sincerity / Authenticity

Middle Ages (Medieval Period) 14th-15th Century

- Thomas Aquinas
 - “The angelic doctor.”
 - First principles of action
 - “Virtue denotes a certain perfection of a power. Now a thing's perfection is considered chiefly in regard to its end. But the end of power is act. Wherefore power is said to be perfect, according as it is determinate to its act.”
 - four cardinal virtues, prudence, temperance, justice, and fortitude
 - The cardinal virtues are natural and revealed in nature, and they are binding on everyone.
 - Three theological virtues: faith, hope and charity

Contemporary Period – 16th Century

- Immanuel Kant
 - Ethics of duty
 - Categorical imperative
 - Duty – do our duty as “universal law”
 - No “ifs”/”buts” or conditions.
- John Paul Sartre (Existentialism)
 - “Existence precedes essence.”

Contemporary Period – 16th Century

- Alvin Toffler (Futurism)
 - Transcience, novelty, diversity → characteristics of the world
 - Future shock (people suffers)
 - Super industrialism
 - Throw-away society.

Contemporary Period – 16th Century

- Utilitarianism (Jeremy Bentham and John Stuart Mill)
 - Pragmatism – a reasonable and logical way of doing things or of thinking about problems that is based on dealing with specific situations instead of on ideas and theories.
 - Use of things
 - The greatest good should benefit the greatest number of people.
 - is generally held to be the view that the morally right action is the action that produces the most good.
 - form of consequentialism: the right action is understood entirely in terms of consequences produced

Contemporary Period – 16th Century

- Rawl Theory Justice (John Rawl)
 - society should be structured, how should basic rights and duties be assigned to individuals, and how should social and economic advantages be distributed to all members of society
 - Principle of justice → ideal society → equality

Contemporary Period – 16th Century

- Egoism
 - Attempting to get personal recognition for yourself (especially by unacceptable means)
 - Egocentrism → self-interest, self-concern, self-centeredness
 - The doctrine of certain extreme adherents or disciples of Descartes and Johann Gottlieb Fichte, which finds all the elements of knowledge in the ego and the relations which it implies or provides for.
 - Excessive love and thought of self; the habit of regarding one's self as the center of every interest; selfishness

Focus of Western Ethics

- SELF
 - Personalism
 - Individual excellence
 - How to be good man, virtued man

Eastern Ethics (Oriental)

- Mahatma Gandhi
 - Hinduism
 - Gandhian Principle
 - Truth
 - Non-violence
 - Faith
 - Simplicity
 - Sarvodaya → universal upliftment or progress for all
 - “An eye for an eye makes the whole world blind.”
 - A “**No**” uttered from the deepest conviction is better than “**Yes**” that was said just to please.

Eastern Ethics (Oriental)

- Confucius
 - Confucianism (Chinese Principle)
 - Human centeredness
 - “Do unto others what you want others to do unto you.”
 - In-favor of filial piety (respect of the elders)
 - The only relation remains is friendship; no family to eliminate selfishness.
 - Division is by age or gender; not by class
 - Started with small tranquility
 - When do something good, do not remember it

Eastern Ethics (Oriental)

- Gautama Buddha
 - Buddhism
 - Not to do evil
 - Most people do evil out of fear.

Focus of Eastern Ethics

- Selves in harmony with or relation to OTHERS.

Activity 1.3 *(1 page per item) – 10 points*



- How will you apply the 5 P's (Purpose, Pride, Patience, Persistence, and Perspective) in your own life? Explain by citing specific situations.
- Identify one ethical issue / problem for each of the four areas (Family, Education / School, Work, and Environment) and suggest ways to resolve these four different issues. Align your answers with the Western and Eastern Ethics.